AP European History FRQ (SAQ+DBQ+LEQ) Guide

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The 5 Themes (every SAQ/FRQ falls into at least one)

1. INT – Interaction of Europe and the World
2. PP – Poverty & Prosperity
3. SP – States and Other Institutions of Power
4. OS – Social Organization & Everyday Life
5. NI – National & European Identity

The 4 Chronological Periods

- Period 1: 1450–1648
- Period 2: 1648–1815
- Period 3: 1815–1914
- Period 4: 1914–present

PERIOD 1 MUST-KNOW (1450-1648)

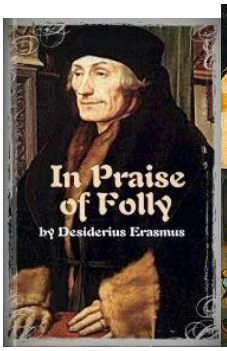
Key ideas for SAQ/FRQ: Renaissance humanism, Protestant Reformation causes/effects, religious wars, new monarchies, Age of Exploration.

Italian Renaissance

Humanism, civic humanism, art

1. Petrarch recovered the letters of Cicero and is called the "Father of Humanism"; he prompted the study of classical Latin.
2. Lorenzo Valla used philology to prove the *Donation of Constantine* a forgery, undermining papal authority.
3. Castiglione's *The Courtier* (1528) described the ideal courtier as educated, eloquent, physically strong, and skilled in arms—a blueprint for elite behavior.

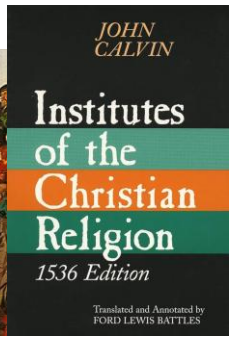
Northern Renaissance



Christian humanism, focus on everyday life

1. Erasmus' *In Praise of Folly* (1511) satirized corrupt monks and superstitious practices, advancing reform without leaving the Church.
2. Pieter Bruegel the Elder painted *Netherlandish Proverbs* (1559), depicting dozens of peasant scenes, embodying the Northern focus on ordinary people.
3. Thomas More's *Utopia* (1516) described an imaginary perfect island society, criticizing contemporary European social and political life.

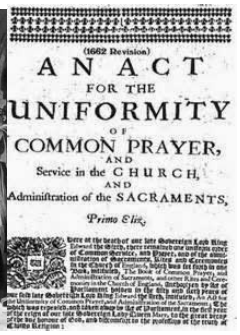
Protestant Reformation



Causes, spread, core doctrines

1. Luther's 95 Theses (1517) attacked the sale of indulgences; they spread across Germany within two weeks thanks to the printing press.
2. At the Diet of Worms (1521) Luther refused to recant, stating "Here I stand, I can do no other," and was excommunicated.
3. John Calvin's *Institutes of the Christian Religion* (1536) systematized Protestant doctrine, especially predestination and the idea of the "elect"; he turned Geneva into a theocracy.

English Reformation



Top-down reform, consolidation of power

1. Henry VIII's Act of Supremacy (1534) declared the king "Supreme Head on earth of the Church of England," breaking with Rome.
2. The Dissolution of the Monasteries (1536–1540) seized monastic land and wealth, redistributing it to the crown and gentry.
3. Elizabeth I's Act of Uniformity (1559) mandated the use of the Book of Common Prayer and fined those who failed to attend Anglican services (worship on Sunday), creating a "via media."

French Wars of Religion

Catholic-Huguenot conflict, Edict of Nantes

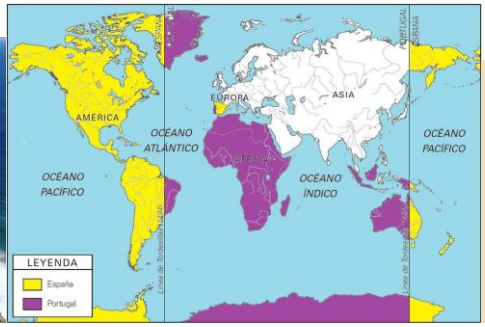
1. St Bartholomew's Day Massacre (1572) saw thousands of Huguenots murdered after the wedding of Henry of Navarre, orchestrated by Catherine de' Medici.
2. Henry of Navarre converted to Catholicism, reportedly saying "Paris is well worth a Mass" (winning Paris by converting to Catholicism was worth it), and issued the Edict of Nantes (1598) granting Huguenots limited toleration.
3. The War of the Three Henrys (Henry III, Henry of Guise, Henry of Navarre) ended when Henry III had Guise assassinated and allied with Navarre.

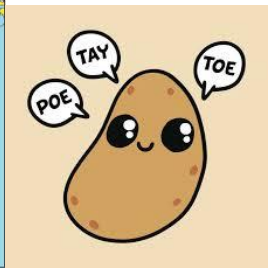
Thirty Years' War & Peace of Westphalia

Religious to political conflict, sovereignty

1. Defenestration of Prague (1618) – Bohemian Protestant nobles threw two imperial officials out of a window, triggering the war.
2. Gustavus Adolphus of Sweden entered the war in 1630 with a disciplined standing army, swinging momentum to the Protestants before dying at Lützen (1632).
3. Peace of Westphalia (1648) recognized Calvinism as a legitimate faith, affirmed the sovereignty of over 300 German states, and ended religious wars.

Age of Exploration & Columbian Exchange





Motives, technology, consequences

1. Prince Henry the Navigator sponsored Portuguese voyages along the African coast, establishing a school for navigators at Sagres.
2. The Treaty of Tordesillas (1494) drew a line of demarcation giving Spain claims west and Portugal east, allowing Portugal to later claim Brazil.
3. The potato and maize from the Americas dramatically increased European calorie intake, while Old World smallpox killed up to 90% of some indigenous populations (the Great Dying).

New Monarchies

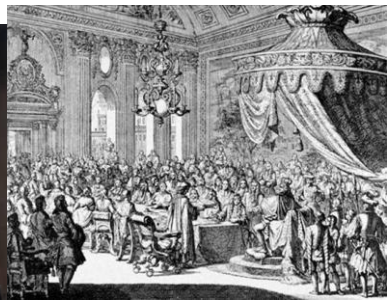
Centralization through tax, bureaucracy, religion

1. Ferdinand and Isabella created a national tax on property transactions and a large bureaucracy to collect it, centralizing royal authority in Spain.
2. The Concordat of Bologna (1516) allowed Francis I of France to appoint bishops and abbots, controlling church revenues and personnel.
3. Henry VII of England used the Star Chamber to repress over-mighty nobles and avoided costly foreign wars, restoring royal finances.

PERIOD 2 MUST-KNOW (1648-1815)

Key ideas: Absolutism vs. constitutionalism, Scientific Revolution, Enlightenment, French Revolution, Napoleon.

Absolutism – France



Louis XIV, Colbert, religious uniformity

1. Louis XIV built the Palace of Versailles, forcing the nobility to reside there so he could monitor them and strip them of independent power.
2. Jean-Baptiste Colbert managed mercantilist policies, abolishing internal tariffs, promoting domestic industry, and building a navy.
3. The Revocation of the Edict of Nantes (1685) with the Edict of Fontainebleau caused over 200,000 Huguenots (many skilled artisans) to flee France.

Constitutionalism – England

Civil War, Glorious Revolution, Bill of Rights

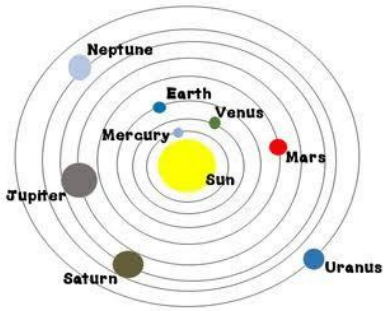
1. Charles I attempted to rule without Parliament during the "Eleven Years' Tyranny" (1629-1640), raising money through forced loans and ship money.
2. The New Model Army, led by Oliver Cromwell, defeated royalist forces; the Rump Parliament tried and executed Charles I in 1649.
3. The English Bill of Rights (1689) forbade a standing army in peacetime without Parliament's consent and guaranteed free elections.

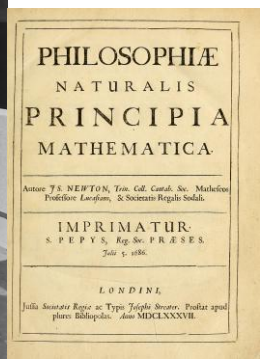
Dutch Golden Age

Republic, finance, trade

1. The Bank of Amsterdam (1609) pioneered modern banking, accepting deposits and issuing trusted bills of exchange with double-entry bookkeeping.
2. The Dutch East India Company (VOC) was the first transnational corporation, raising capital by selling shares and dominating the spice trade.
3. Hugo Grotius published *The Freedom of the Seas* (1609), arguing that the sea was international territory and defending Dutch maritime trade.

Scientific Revolution

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Autore J. S. NEWTON, Trin. Coll. Cantab. Soc. Matheseos Professore Lucasiano, & Societatis Regalis Sodali.

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Julii 5. 1686.

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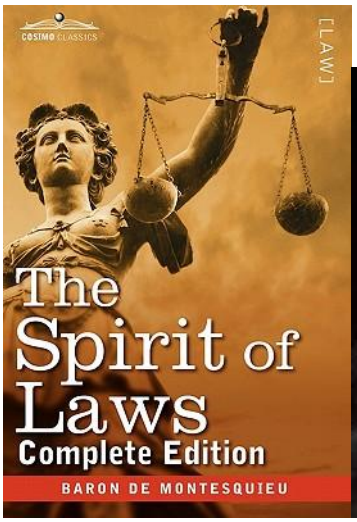
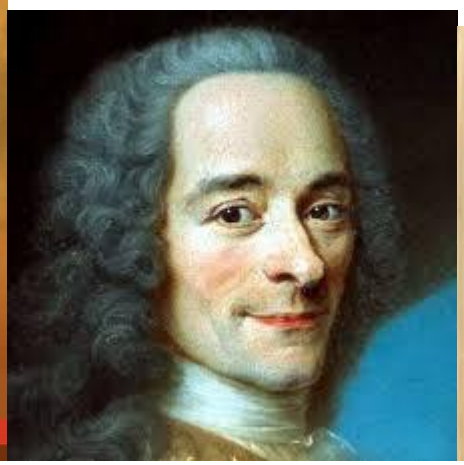
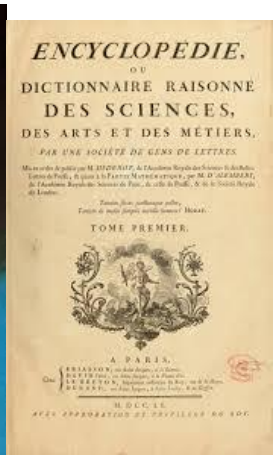
Heliocentrism, empiricism, Newton

1. Copernicus' *On the Revolutions of the Heavenly Spheres* (1543) proposed a heliocentric model; it was later placed on the Index of Prohibited Books.
2. Galileo built an improved telescope, observed Jupiter's moons, and stood trial before the Roman Inquisition in 1633, recanting under threat of torture.
3. Newton's *Principia Mathematica* (1687) laid out the law of universal gravitation, principles of calculus, unifying celestial and terrestrial mechanics.

Enlightenment



Reason, natural rights, economic ideas

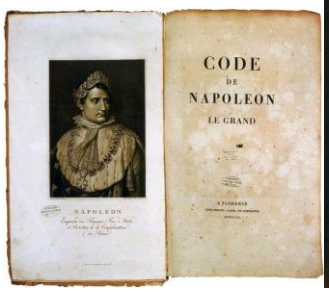
1. Montesquieu's *Spirit of the Laws* (1748) argued for separation of powers into executive, legislative, and judicial branches.
2. Voltaire praised English religious toleration and limited monarchy in his *Letters on the English* (1733) after living in exile in England.
3. Diderot's *Encyclopédie* (1751–1772), comprising over 72,000 articles, disseminated Enlightenment ideas and was condemned by the Catholic Church.

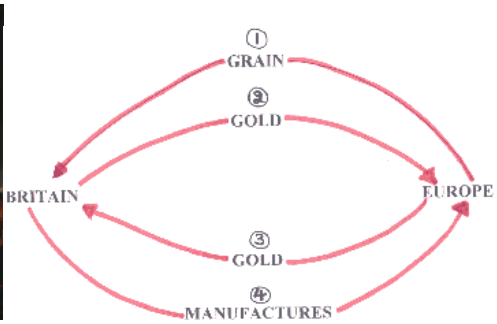
French Revolution – Causes & Liberal Phase

Estates system, National Assembly, early reforms

1. The Estates General (1789) voting by order meant the First and Second Estates always outvoted the Third Estate (97% of the population).
2. Tennis Court Oath (20 June 1789) – the National Assembly swore not to disband until they had written a constitution.
3. Declaration of the Rights of Man and Citizen (August 1789) proclaimed "men are born and remain free and equal in rights," but excluded women.

French Revolution – Radical Phase





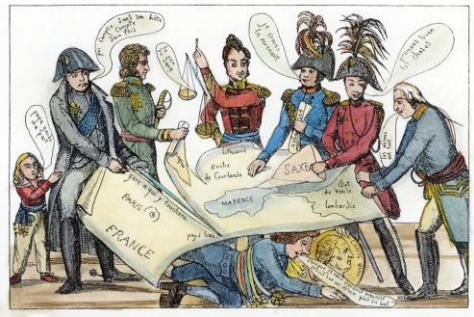
Republic, Terror, mass mobilization

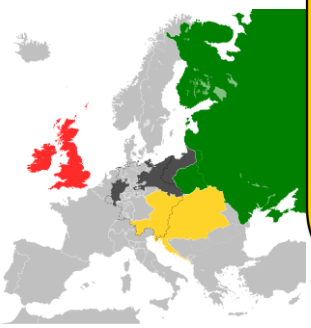
1. Louis XVI was executed by guillotine on 21 January 1793, marking the end of monarchy and horrifying other European rulers.
2. The Committee of Public Safety, led by Robespierre, instituted the Reign of Terror; the Law of 22 Prairial (1794) accelerated executions, sending over 16,000 to the guillotine.
3. The levée en masse (August 1793) declared compulsory military service for all unmarried men aged 18–25, creating the largest army Europe had seen.

Domestic reforms, empire, downfall

1. The Napoleonic Code (1804) enshrined equality before the law and protection of property, but made women legally subordinate to their husbands.
2. The Concordat of 1801 with Pope Pius VII restored the Church but kept the state superior: Napoleon nominated bishops and paid clergy.
3. The Continental System attempted to blockade British trade; Russia's withdrawal in 1810 prompted Napoleon's disastrous invasion of 1812.

Congress of Vienna





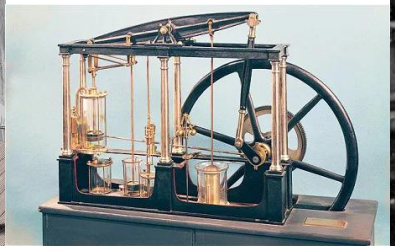
Conservatism, balance of power, Concert of Europe

1. Metternich of Austria led the Congress, pushing the principle of legitimacy and restoring Bourbon rulers in France, Spain, and Naples.
2. The Quadruple Alliance (Austria, Prussia, Russia, Great Britain) agreed to meet periodically to maintain peace, creating the Concert of Europe.
3. The German Confederation was created as a loose union of 39 states under Austrian presidency, deliberately keeping Germany fragmented.

PERIOD 3 MUST-KNOW (1815-1914)

Key ideas: Industrialization, 'isms' (liberalism, socialism, nationalism), unification of Italy & Germany, New Imperialism.

Industrial Revolution – First Wave

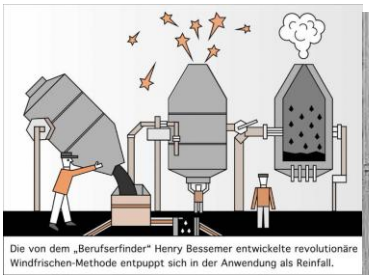


Textiles, steam, social effects

1. James Hargreaves' spinning jenny (1764) allowed one worker to spin multiple threads, dramatically increasing yarn output.
2. The steam engine improved by James Watt (patented 1769) became a rotary engine powering factory machinery, freeing factories from water-power.

3. The Factory Act of 1833 (UK) prohibited children under 9 from working in textile mills and limited hours for older children, setting a precedent for government intervention.

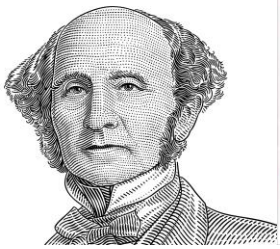
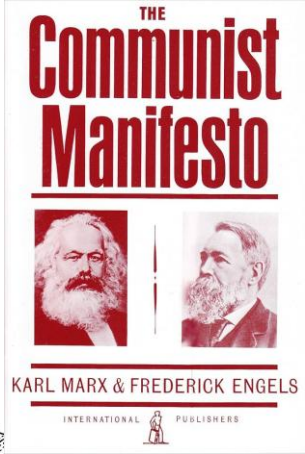
Industrial Revolution – Second Wave



Steel, chemicals, communications

1. The Bessemer process (1856) enabled mass-produced cheap steel; the Krupp family in Germany perfected it, becoming Europe's largest armaments supplier.
2. The telegraph, invented by Morse, connected the UK and the US by 1866 via an underwater cable, transforming global communication.
3. Vulcanization (Goodyear, 1844) treated rubber with sulphur to make it durable, essential for tyres, insulation, and industrial belts.

Ideologies – Liberalism, Socialism, Conservatism, Nationalism

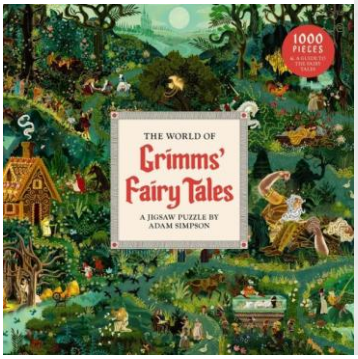



Key thinkers and policies

1. John Stuart Mill (liberal utilitarian) wrote *On Liberty* (1859) defending individual freedom and *The Subjection of Women* (1869) challenging gender inequality.
2. Karl Marx and Friedrich Engels published *The Communist Manifesto* (1848) with the line "Workers of the world, unite!"

3. The Carlsbad Decrees (1819) suppressed liberal and nationalist student groups and imposed press censorship across the German Confederation—a classic conservative response.

Nationalism in Action



Cultural and political expressions

1. The Grimm brothers collected *Grimm's Fairy Tales* (1812), consciously fostering a shared German cultural identity through folk stories.
2. Theodor Herzl founded modern political Zionism and published *The Jewish State* (1896) in response to the Dreyfus Affair.
3. Pan-Slavism was championed by Russia as protector of Slavic peoples in the Balkans, contributing to the Crimean War and later tensions.

Unification of Italy

Cavour, Garibaldi, completion

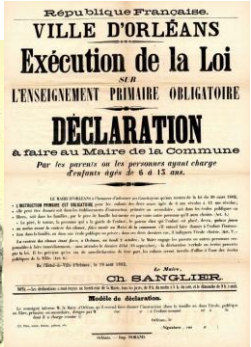
1. (Northern Italy) Count Cavour, Prime Minister of Piedmont-Sardinia, modernised the economy and allied with Napoleon III to provoke the Austro-Sardinian War (1859).
2. (Southern Italy) Giuseppe Garibaldi led the Expedition of the Thousand (1860), sailing with 1,000 Red Shirts to conquer Sicily and Naples.
3. After French troops withdrew from Rome during the Franco-Prussian War (1870), Victor Emmanuel II seized the city, completing unification.

Unification of Germany

Bismarck, "blood and iron," three wars

1. Bismarck bypassed parliament to expand the army, stating: "The great questions of the day will not be settled by speeches … but by blood and iron."
2. The Ems Dispatch (1870) was edited by Bismarck to provoke France into declaring war, rallying southern German states to Prussia.
3. The German Empire was proclaimed in the Hall of Mirrors at Versailles on 18 January 1871, humiliating France.

Domestic Reforms – Urban Planning & Education



Haussmann, public health, compulsory education

1. Baron Haussmann demolished crowded medieval Paris, created wide boulevards that prevented barricades, and built parks and a modern sewer system (1850s-60s).
2. Britain's Public Health Act (1848), prompted by Edwin Chadwick's reports, authorized local boards of health to improve water and drainage.
3. In France, the Jules Ferry Laws (1881-82) made primary education free, mandatory, and secular.

New Imperialism

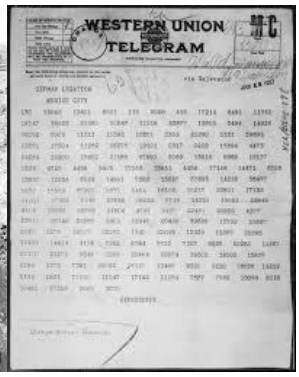
Congo, Berlin Conference, economic imperialism in Asia

1. King Leopold II of Belgium personally controlled the Congo Free State (1885); forced rubber quotas enforced by mutilation and murder led to millions of deaths.
2. The Berlin Conference (1884-85), called by Bismarck, set rules for dividing Africa; no African representatives were allowed.
3. Britain's Opium Wars (1839-42, 1856-60) forced China to open ports, cede Hong Kong, and legalize the opium trade—a clear example of economic imperialism.

PERIOD 4, PART 1 (1914-1945)

Key ideas: WWI causes/effects, Russian Revolution, interwar economic crisis, rise of fascism/Stalinism, WWII.

World War I



Causes, total war, technology

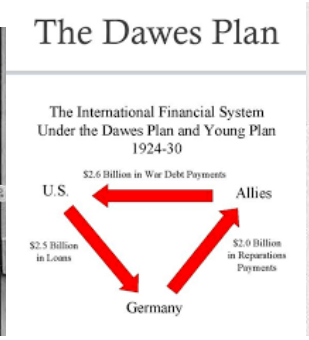
1. The Schlieffen Plan (1905) called for Germany to defeat France by swinging through Belgium; Britain entered over Belgian neutrality.
2. Poison gas was first used by Germany at the Second Battle of Ypres (April 1915), killing men by suffocation within minutes.
3. The Zimmermann Telegram (1917) offered Mexico an alliance against the US; intercepted by Britain, it helped draw the US into the war.

Russian Revolution

Bolshevik takeover, civil war, Lenin

1. Lenin's April Theses (1917) demanded "Peace, Land, Bread," immediate Soviet power, and withdrawal from WWI.
2. The Bolsheviks stormed the Winter Palace in October 1917, arresting the Provisional Government with minimal bloodshed.
3. The Red Army, organized by Leon Trotsky, used conscription, former tsarist officers, and terror to win the civil war (1918-1922).

Interwar Economic Crisis



Hyperinflation, Dawes Plan, Great Depression

1. German hyperinflation peaked in 1923: a loaf of bread cost billions of marks, wiping out middle-class savings.
2. The Dawes Plan (1924) lent Germany US money to pay reparations, stabilizing the economy temporarily.

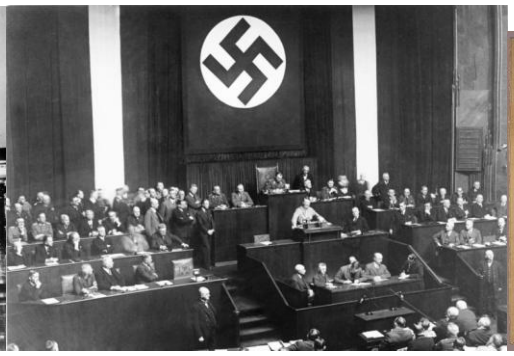
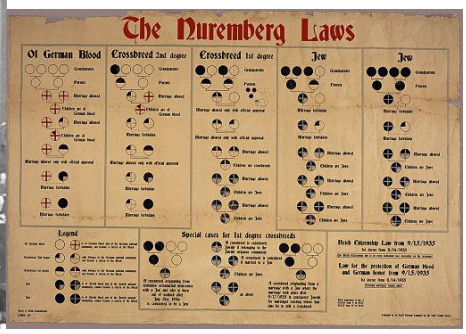
3. Black Thursday (24 October 1929) on Wall Street triggered the Great Depression; by 1932 nearly 40% of the German workforce was unemployed.

Fascism – Italy

Mussolini, consolidation, Church relations

1. Mussolini's March on Rome (October 1922) brought 30,000 Blackshirts to the capital, prompting the king to appoint him prime minister.
2. The Acerbo Law (1923) gave Mussolini's party two-thirds of parliamentary seats with only 25% of the vote, ending democracy.
3. The Lateran Accords (1929) created Vatican City and made Catholicism the state religion; in return, the papacy recognized the Italian state.

Fascism – Germany

Hitler, Enabling Act, racial laws

1. The Reichstag Fire (27 February 1933) was used as a pretext for the Reichstag Fire Decree, suspending civil liberties.
2. The Enabling Act (March 1933) granted Hitler plenary powers for four years; after Hindenburg's death he merged the offices of president and chancellor.
3. The Nuremberg Laws (1935) stripped Jews of citizenship and banned marriage between Jews and "Aryans", laying the legal foundation for the Holocaust.

Stalin's USSR

Five-Year Plans, collectivisation, purges

1. The First Five-Year Plan (1928-1932) focused on heavy industry; official output doubled, but quality and worker welfare suffered terribly.
2. Collectivization forced peasants into state farms; "dekulakisation" led to the Holodomor (1932-33), which killed an estimated 5 million Ukrainians.
3. The Great Purge (1936-1938) saw show trials and executions of old Bolsheviks, with approximately 600,000 to 1.2 million killed.

World War II

Appeasement, key turning points, total war

1. Appeasement at the Munich Conference (September 1938) gave Hitler the Sudetenland; British PM Neville Chamberlain returned claiming "peace for our time."
2. The Nazi-Soviet Non-Aggression Pact (Molotov-Ribbentrop, 1939) secretly agreed to divide Poland, enabling the invasion on 1 September.
3. D-Day (6 June 1944), Operation Overlord, landed 156,000 Allied troops on the beaches of Normandy, opening the Western front.

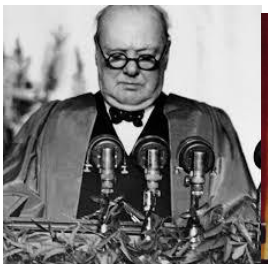
Holocaust

Final Solution, camps, death toll

1. The Wannsee Conference (20 January 1942) formally coordinated the "Final Solution," planning the extermination of 11 million European Jews.
2. Auschwitz-Birkenau, the largest death camp, used Zyklon B gas; its crematoria could incinerate over 4,000 bodies per day.
3. Approximately 6 million Jews were murdered, along with millions of others: Roma, disabled individuals, homosexuals, and Soviet POWs.

PERIOD 4, PART 2 (POST-1945 TO PRESENT)

Cold War – Origins & Containment



Speech, doctrine, aid

1. Churchill's "Iron Curtain" speech (1946) declared that an iron curtain had descended "from Stettin in the Baltic to Trieste in the Adriatic."
2. The Truman Doctrine (1947) committed the US to supporting "free peoples who are resisting attempted subjugation," first applied in Greece and Turkey.
3. The Marshall Plan (1947) offered $13 billion in aid; Stalin forced Eastern Bloc nations to reject it, deepening Europe's division.

Cold War – Crises & Arms Race

Berlin, nuclear, Cuba

1. The Berlin Blockade (1948-1949) lasted 322 days; the Western Allies airlifted over 2 million tons of supplies in 270,000 flights.
2. The Soviet Union tested its first atomic bomb in August 1949, four years earlier than US intelligence expected.
3. The Cuban Missile Crisis (October 1962) brought the world to the brink of nuclear war; the crisis ended when Khrushchev withdrew missiles and Kennedy secretly agreed to remove US missiles from Turkey.

Decolonization

India, Algeria, Africa

1. Indian independence (1947) was accompanied by partition into India and Pakistan, resulting in massive migration and over a million dead in communal violence.
2. The Algerian War (1954-1962) between the French government and the FLN resulted in over 300,000 deaths; de Gaulle granted independence after a referendum.
3. Ghana, led by Kwame Nkrumah, became the first sub-Saharan African colony to achieve independence (from Britain) in 1957, a symbol for Pan-Africanism.

European Union

From Coal and Steel Community to euro

1. The Schuman Declaration (May 1950) proposed pooling French and German coal and steel, leading to the European Coal and Steel Community (1951).
2. The Treaty of Rome (1957) established the European Economic Community (Common Market), committing to free movement of goods, services, people, and capital.
3. The Maastricht Treaty (1993) created the modern EU and laid out criteria for the single currency, the euro, launched in 1999.

Women's Rights – 20th Century

Second-wave feminism, reproductive rights, political representation

1. Simone de Beauvoir published *The Second Sex* (1949), arguing that "one is not born, but rather becomes, a woman"—a foundational text of second-wave feminism.
2. The contraceptive pill, developed with funding from Margaret Sanger, was approved in the US in 1960 and in France (Neuwirth Law) in 1967, giving women control over reproduction.
3. Margaret Thatcher became Britain's first female prime minister in 1979, implementing privatization and free-market policies over 11 years.

Collapse of Communism

Solidarity, Berlin Wall, dissolution of USSR

1. Solidarity led by Lech Wałęsa won recognition through the Round Table Agreement (1989) and then won elections, forming the first non-communist government in the Eastern Bloc.
2. The Berlin Wall fell on 9 November 1989 after a confused official announced immediate emigration rights.
3. Gorbachev's glasnost and perestroika, along with his refusal to use force, led to the dissolution of the USSR on 25 December 1991.

Migration & Anti-Immigrant Politics (Post-WWII)

Guest workers, new parties, Brexit

1. Guest worker programs brought Turks to Germany and North Africans to France during the economic boom of the 1950s-60s, often with the expectation of eventual return.
2. The French National Front, founded by Jean-Marie Le Pen, gained electoral success in the 1980s on an anti-immigration platform, winning 14% in the 1988 presidential election.
3. Brexit (2016) was partly driven by anti-immigration sentiment; the UK formally left the EU on 31 January 2020.

HIGH-YIELD SAQ TOPICS & SAMPLE PROMPTS

Use the specifics above to answer any of these common SAQ tasks.

Topic	Sample SAQ Task
Renaissance Humanism	A) Describe one characteristic of Renaissance humanism. B) Explain one way humanism affected education. C) Explain how humanism influenced art.
Protestant Reformation	A) Explain one cause of the Reformation. B) Explain one factor that helped the Reformation spread. C) Explain one political effect of the Reformation.
Scientific Revolution	A) Describe one new theory about the universe. B) Explain one way the Church responded. C) Explain how this period changed methods of reasoning.
Enlightenment ideas	A) Explain one key political idea of an Enlightenment thinker. B) Explain how that idea challenged traditional authority. C) Explain one way Enlightenment ideas influenced the French Revolution.
French Revolution	A) Explain one cause of the French Revolution. B) Explain one change made during the Liberal Phase. C) Explain one consequence of the Reign of Terror.
Industrial Revolution	A) Describe one reason the IR began in Britain. B) Explain one social effect of industrialization. C) Explain how governments responded to problems of industrialization.
Nationalism	A) Explain one factor that promoted 19th-century nationalism. B) Explain one way nationalism contributed to German unification. C) Explain one negative consequence of nationalism.
New Imperialism	A) Explain one economic motive for New Imperialism. B) Explain one technological advantage Europeans had. C) Explain one way indigenous people resisted.
World War I	A) Explain one long-term cause of WWI. B) Explain one effect of total war on the home front. C) Explain one consequence of the Treaty of Versailles.
Cold War	A) Explain one purpose of the Marshall Plan. B) Explain one way the Soviet Union controlled Eastern Europe. C) Explain one factor that led to the end of the Cold War.

Women's Rights	A) Describe one goal of first-wave feminism. B) Explain one achievement of second-wave feminism. C) Explain one obstacle faced by the women's movement.

SAQ SAMPLE RESPONSE

Renaissance Humanism

A) Describe one characteristic of Renaissance humanism.

- Emphasized the unlimited potential of human beings.
- Believed education in the classical liberal arts (rhetoric, grammar, history, moral philosophy) led to virtue and wisdom.
- Marked a shift away from medieval theology toward celebrating human achievement.

B) Explain one way humanism affected education.

- Replaced a narrowly religious curriculum with the studia humanitatis, a program of classical studies.
- Petrarch revived the study of Cicero's Latin, inspiring new educational ideals.
- Vittorino da Feltre founded a school in Mantua that combined classical texts with physical exercise to prepare students for active civic life.

C) Explain how humanism influenced art.

- Led artists to adopt naturalism and geometric perspective, abandoning flat, symbolic medieval styles.
- Leonardo da Vinci used accurate anatomy and perspective, as in The Last Supper, where the room's architecture draws the viewer's eye to Christ.

Protestant Reformation

A) Explain one cause of the Reformation.

- Widespread resentment over the Church's fiscal abuses, especially the sale of indulgences.
- Pope Leo X authorized indulgence sales to finance St. Peter's Basilica.
- Martin Luther attacked the idea that salvation could be purchased in his 95 Theses (1517).

B) Explain one factor that helped the Reformation spread.

- The printing press allowed rapid, mass circulation of reformist ideas.
- Luther's 95 Theses spread across German states within weeks.

- By 1523, vernacular New Testaments were available, letting ordinary people read Scripture without church intermediaries.

C) Explain one political effect of the Reformation.

- Rulers consolidated power at the Church's expense.
- Henry VIII's Act of Supremacy (1534) declared him Supreme Head of the Church of England.
- He seized Church lands and ended papal authority within his realm.

Scientific Revolution

A) Describe one new theory about the universe.

- Copernicus proposed the heliocentric theory, placing the Sun at the center.
- His On the Revolutions of the Heavenly Spheres (1543) used mathematics to challenge the Ptolemaic geocentric model.
- The Earth and other planets were shown to revolve around the Sun.

B) Explain one way the Church responded.

- The Catholic Church placed Copernicus's work on the Index of Prohibited Books.
- When Galileo used his telescope to support heliocentrism, the Roman Inquisition tried him in 1633.
- Galileo was forced to recant and was placed under house arrest.

C) Explain how this period changed methods of reasoning.

- Introduced empiricism and the scientific method.
- Francis Bacon advocated inductive reasoning (specific observations → general conclusions).
- Descartes championed deductive reasoning, doubting everything except his own existence ("I think, therefore I am").

Enlightenment ideas

A) Explain one key political idea of an Enlightenment thinker.

- John Locke's Second Treatise on Civil Government held that individuals have natural rights to life, liberty, and property.
- These rights are granted by God and cannot be taken by any ruler.
- Government authority derives from the consent of the governed, not divine right.

B) Explain how that idea challenged traditional authority.

- It directly challenged the divine right of kings, which held that monarchs answered only to God.

- Locke argued that if a ruler violated the people's rights, the people had the right to overthrow him.
- This undermined the entire basis of absolutist monarchy.

C) Explain one way Enlightenment ideas influenced the French Revolution.

- The Declaration of the Rights of Man and Citizen (1789) was shaped by Rousseau and Locke.
- It proclaimed that "men are born and remain free and equal in rights."
- It asserted that sovereignty resides in the nation, echoing the social contract and rejecting aristocratic privilege.

French Revolution

A) Explain one cause of the French Revolution.

- A fiscal crisis and an unjust tax system.
- France's war debt fell entirely on the Third Estate (commoners), while clergy and nobility were exempt.
- Bread shortages in 1788-1789 intensified anger against the regime.

B) Explain one change made during the Liberal Phase.

- The National Assembly passed the Civil Constitution of the Clergy (1790).
- It nationalized Church lands, disbanded monastic orders, and required clergy to swear loyalty to the state.
- This subordinated the Catholic Church to the revolutionary government.

C) Explain one consequence of the Reign of Terror.

- About 16,000 people were officially guillotined under the Law of 22 Prairial.
- Robespierre's execution in July 1794 triggered the Thermidorian Reaction, a conservative backlash.
- The radical phase ended, eventually paving the way for Napoleon's rise.

Industrial Revolution

A) Describe one reason the IR began in Britain.

- Abundant deposits of coal and iron ore.
- These essential raw materials powered steam engines and built machinery.
- A developed network of roads and canals moved these resources cheaply to industrial centers.

B) Explain one social effect of industrialization.

- Rapid growth of a new working class (proletariat) working in factories and mines under harsh conditions.

- Many lived in overcrowded tenements with poor ventilation and no indoor plumbing.
- Diseases like tuberculosis spread, while the middle class (bourgeoisie) moved to more comfortable suburbs.

C) Explain how governments responded to problems of industrialisation.

- Protective legislation like Britain's Factory Act of 1833.
- It prohibited children under nine from working in textile mills and limited older children's hours.
- The Ten Hours Act (1847) further restricted the workday, showing a shift from laissez-faire to state intervention.

Nationalism

A) Explain one factor that promoted 19th-century nationalism.

- Romantic idealism glorified a people's shared language, history, and folklore.
- The Grimm brothers collected German fairy tales (1812) to foster a common German cultural identity.
- Romantic poets and historians celebrated national heroes and myths.

B) Explain one way nationalism contributed to German unification.

- Bismarck harnessed nationalist sentiment to rally support for Prussia's unification wars.
- He edited the Ems Dispatch (1870) to provoke France into declaring war.
- The ensuing nationalist outrage led southern German states to join Prussia, completing unification.

C) Explain one negative consequence of nationalism.

- Extreme nationalism spawned racialism and anti-Semitism.
- The Dreyfus Affair (1894-1906) in France revealed deep anti-Jewish prejudice.
- Captain Alfred Dreyfus was falsely convicted of treason largely because of his Jewish identity, sparking anti-Semitic violence.

New Imperialism

A) Explain one economic motive for New Imperialism.

- Industrial powers needed raw materials and new markets for manufactured goods.
- After Britain took direct control of India following the Sepoy Rebellion, it exploited Indian cotton and jute.
- India also became a captive market for British textiles and industrial products.

B) Explain one technological advantage Europeans had.

- Advanced weaponry such as breech-loading rifles and the Maxim machine gun.
- The Maxim gun fired hundreds of rounds per minute.
- At the Battle of Omdurman (1898), British forces killed thousands of Sudanese while losing only a few dozen men.

C) Explain one way indigenous people resisted.

- King Menelik II of Ethiopia played European powers against one another.
- He imported modern rifles and artillery from France and Russia.
- At the Battle of Adwa (1896), his army decisively defeated the Italians, keeping Ethiopia independent.

World War I

A) Explain one long-term cause of WWI.

- The system of secret and entangling alliances made escalation likely.
- The Triple Alliance (Germany, Austria-Hungary, Italy) and Triple Entente (Britain, France, Russia) were rigidly drawn.
- Austria-Hungary's declaration on Serbia pulled all major powers into war within weeks.

B) Explain one effect of total war on the home front.

- Governments took control of industries and rationed food.
- In Britain, the Defence of the Realm Act allowed seizure of factories to convert textile mills into munitions plants.
- Civilians faced severe shortages and price controls, fundamentally expanding state power.

C) Explain one consequence of the Treaty of Versailles.

- The "war guilt clause" (Article 231) and massive reparations humiliated and economically crippled Germany.
- Resentment over lost territory and military restrictions created a fertile ground for extremism.
- Adolf Hitler later exploited these grievances to gain support.

Cold War

A) Explain one purpose of the Marshall Plan.

- To rebuild war-torn Western European economies and prevent the spread of communism.
- The U.S. feared poverty would drive Europeans toward communist parties.

- It provided $13 billion in aid to revive industry and stabilize democratic governments.

B) Explain one way the Soviet Union controlled Eastern Europe.

- It established the Warsaw Pact (1955), a military alliance making satellites dependent on Moscow.
- Secret police and the threat of intervention enforced conformity.
- The USSR crushed the Hungarian Revolution (1956) and the Prague Spring (1968) to prevent deviation.

C) Explain one factor that led to the end of the Cold War.

- Gorbachev's policies of glasnost (openness) and perestroika (restructuring) weakened Soviet control.
- He announced in 1989 that the USSR would no longer intervene militarily in Eastern Bloc states.
- This emboldened revolutions, leading to the fall of the Berlin Wall and the dissolution of the USSR in 1991.

Women's Rights

A) Describe one goal of first-wave feminism.

- To secure women's suffrage.
- Groups like the Women's Social and Political Union (WSPU) in Britain, led by the Pankhurst family, used militant tactics.
- They organized mass rallies, hunger strikes, and protests demanding the right to vote.

B) Explain one achievement of second-wave feminism.

- Secured reproductive rights, especially access to the contraceptive pill.
- The pill was approved in the United States (1960) and legalized in France by the Neuwirth Law (1967).
- It gave women control over their fertility, enabling independent choices about marriage and careers.

C) Explain one obstacle faced by the women's movement.

- Deep-rooted cultural and religious opposition to redefining traditional gender roles.
- The Roman Catholic Church condemned the pill and abortion, arguing that God alone controls the womb.
- Conservative politicians resisted reforms that threatened the patriarchal family structure.

COMPARISON BANK (FOR LEQ "COMPARE" PROMPTS)

Topic	Comparison
Italian vs. Northern Renaissance	Italian: secular, classical themes, wealthy elites. Northern: Christian humanism, religious reform focus, everyday life.
Absolutism vs. Constitutionalism	France (Louis XIV): divine right, no parliament. England: Bill of Rights, shared power with Parliament.
Scientific Rev vs. Enlightenment	Scientific Rev: nature/world. Enlightenment: society/government. Both used reason.
Liberalism vs. Conservatism (19th c.)	Liberals wanted individual rights, limited government, free markets. Conservatives wanted order, monarchy, church authority.
1st vs. 2nd Industrial Revolution	1st: coal, steam, textiles, started in Great Britain. 2nd: electricity, steel, chemicals, mass production, started in Germany.
Mussolini vs. Hitler	Both fascist. Mussolini: later, less racial initially; Hitler: racial ideology central, more thorough totalitarianism.
WWI vs. WWII	Both total wars. WWII: more civilian deaths, Holocaust, atomic end. WWI ended with treaty; WWII ended with unconditional surrender and Cold War.
First-wave vs. Second-wave feminism	1st: suffrage. 2nd: broader rights (workplace, reproductive, equality in law).

CONTINUITY & CHANGE QUICK-REFERENCE

Theme	Continuity	Change

Religion (1450–today)	Religious institutions remain important.	State control over religion ↓; secularization ↑; religious pluralism grows.
State power (1450–1815)	Monarchs remain central.	Power shifts from nobility/Church to centralized bureaucracies; divine right challenged.
Economy (1450–1815)	Agriculture dominant for most.	Commercial Revolution → mercantilism → capitalism.
Women's roles (1450–2000)	Patriarchal structures persist.	Education/work opportunities expand; legal rights progress, especially after 1900.
Class structure (1648–1914)	Hierarchy exists.	Nobility loses power; bourgeoisie and proletariat emerge as new classes.
European global role (1450–present)	Europe interventionist.	Shift from imperial dominance to decolonization and soft power (EU).
Warfare (1648–1945)	States compete for power.	From limited dynastic wars to total war, mechanization, nuclear era.
Arts (1450–present)	Reflects society.	Renaissance classicism → Baroque → Romanticism → Realism → Modernism → Postmodernism.